

Lava Blaze 2 5G

A must-buy, but not for the 'Ring Light'

Lava's latest offering, the Blaze 2 5G made it to the market in October as a sub-₹10K 5G smartphone.

The brand launched the Blaze 2 5G in India at a price of ₹9,999. Now the question is if the Blaze 2 5G is worth purchasing. Or what are its USPs? I have two answers to these questions – It is one of the very few smartphones that offer 5G connectivity under ₹10,000. And the main USP of the Lava Blaze 2 5G is that it comes with a 'Ring Light', making its design distinctive and attractive at the same time.

I have used this smartphone for a couple of weeks now and here's my review of the Lava Blaze 2 5G.

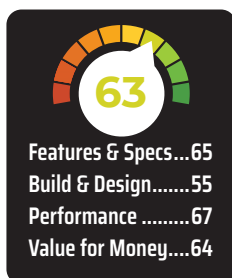
DESIGN

Lava's major selling point for the Blaze 2 5G is its design. The brand has featured a ring light on the smartphone that can be used for notifications. It is surrounded by the camera module. Lava is saying that this is the '1st in the segment ring light'. However, I felt that this ring light was not that great. In pictures and videos, the ring light looks really attractive. However, in reality, if a person doesn't know about it, he won't be able to tell that it's a 'Light'. Its brightness is very dull and it looks like a blue round strip around the camera module when it turns on. This ring light can be used for notifications. Further, it also lights up when you are charging the smartphone.

Moving on, I really liked the overall design of the Blaze 2 5G. It comes with a glass back paired with a plastic mid-frame. I have the Glass Black variant of the smartphone and it really looks gothic but in a good sense. It has a capacitive power button and volume



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rockers on the right side of the panel. On the left, you'll get a SIM tray. At the bottom of the panel, there is a USB Type-C port, a 3.5mm headphone jack, and speakers. Moving to the back, there is an elevated circular camera module, which is not completely a camera module. This module consists of the signature 'Ring Light' along with a dual camera setup. At the bottom left of the panel, you will find the Lava 5G branding.

DISPLAY

The Lava Blaze 2 5G is equipped with a 6.56-inch IPS LCD display. Sadly, Lava offers only an HD+ resolution with this display. Whereas, its competitors such as the Redmi 12 5G and Realme C53 offer an FHD+ resolution. In terms of brightness, the Blaze 2 5G is pretty decent as per the configuration. I ran the display tests on the Blaze 2 5G, which resulted in 429 nits of peak brightness.

Moreover, the display felt quite responsive as it supports a 90Hz refresh rate. Furthermore, the sharpness, however, is lacking in this smartphone

because of the HD+ resolution.

In conclusion, the display of the Blaze 2 5G is doable. But it would have been better if it had an FHD+ resolution. However, it is not a very big problem if you don't watch too much content on your smartphone.

PERFORMANCE

The Lava Blaze 2 5G is powered by the MediaTek Dimensity 6020 processor. It is paired with up to 6GB RAM and 128GB storage. It also comes with one more configuration; 4GB RAM 64GB storage. Furthermore, the Blaze 2 5G runs on Android 13 Operating System.

In my opinion, it performs well while gaming. In 15 minutes of Call of Duty Mobile, the Blaze 2 5G didn't lag in between and ran the game smoothly on high graphics. Since it only supports HD+ resolution, you will be able to play the game at up to 'Medium' graphics and 'High' Frame rate only.

However, it gets heated up a little while running performance-centric operations. But not so much that it would bother you.

Next, if you are a normal user who doesn't go fancy with the smartphone, the Blaze 2 5G is quite good. While using basic applications such as Instagram, WhatsApp, payment apps, and more, the smartphone works fine.

Coming to its OS, this really needs to be fixed in the Blaze 2 5G. The OS is still a little buggy, which leads to 'non-responsive' situations sometimes. I wouldn't say it freezes the smartphone but it's pretty much similar. For instance, I have been through situations where the smartphone stopped responding. It was not frozen as I could see the feedback of taps but it was not responding, that too just after setting up the smartphone, but this can be easily fixed with a software update.

CAMERA

The Lava Blaze 2 5G comes with a dual camera setup, holding a 50-megapixel primary camera and a 0.08-megapixel depth sensor. On the front, there is a 16-megapixel selfie shooter. The Blaze 2 5G can record up to 1440 pixels of video